

Julio Gulas

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Head of Professional Services | Delivery & Professional Services Leader

PMP- and PSM I-certified Delivery and Professional Services leader with 14+ years of experience leading complex software, consulting, and technology initiatives across digital platforms, eCommerce/DXP, cloud, and cybersecurity environments. Proven track record of driving client-facing delivery, building operational structure, and leading cross-functional teams through ambiguity, growth, and change. Recognized for bringing clarity, governance, and execution discipline to multi-project portfolios while strengthening client relationships, improving predictability, and supporting commercial performance through sound scope, forecasting, and resource management.

CORE STRENGTHS

- Professional Services and delivery leadership
- Client-facing project and program execution
- Portfolio governance, reporting, and delivery cadence
- Cross-functional leadership across PM, engineering, QA, design, and partners
- Resource planning, utilization, and capacity management
- Scope control, change management, and commercial governance
- Risk, dependency, and issue management
- Stakeholder alignment and executive communication
- Pre-sales support, discovery, estimation, and onboarding
- Operational improvement, delivery playbooks, and continuous improvement
- Agile / hybrid delivery in software and consulting environments
- eCommerce/DXP, enterprise SaaS, cloud, and cybersecurity delivery

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backbone • Remote (Burnaby, BC, CAN)

Head of Professional Services | Senior Project Manager (Software Delivery) • Full-time **10/2024 – 03/2026**

- Lead Professional Services delivery across North America, aligning portfolio execution, resourcing, and client outcomes across multiple time zones.
- Managed 3 delivery PMs directly and guided 12 cross-functional team members across active engagements.
- Partnered with Finance and leadership on forecasting, utilization tracking, and scope/change management to protect delivery commitments and service performance.
- Built and scaled a PS operating model and reusable delivery playbooks (SOW intake, kickoff standards, RAID/change control, reporting, templates, and client sign-offs), improving predictability, consistency, and onboarding of new PMs.
- Drove practice-level improvements by analyzing portfolio trends (delivery health, resourcing, recurring risks), prioritizing initiatives, and partnering with leadership to evolve offerings, delivery KPIs, and enablement.
- Owned portfolio reporting cadence (weekly status, risks, forecast, utilization/capacity, profitability drivers, and delivery KPIs / client satisfaction).

- Directed high-visibility e-commerce/DXP engagements, coordinating PMs, engineers, QA, design, and vendor partners implementing and enhancing Expresia Digital Experience Platform (DXP) and SaaS-based digital solutions through backlog triage, release planning, and go-live stabilization.
- Strengthened commercial governance by managing scope baseline, change orders, renewals, and upsell conversations in partnership with Sales and executive leadership.
- Implemented resource planning practices to reduce context switching, balance workload across teams, and protect delivery commitments during staffing constraints.
- Mentored project and delivery leads on Agile practices, stakeholder management, and risk communication to elevate consistency across engagements.
- Supported pre-sales and onboarding activities (discovery, estimation, delivery approach, and lightweight sign-off criteria), ensuring seamless sales-to-delivery transitions and reducing downstream ambiguity and rework.
- Led the initial delivery phase of an AI-enabled commerce platform engagement, establishing scope, planning, governance, and cross-functional alignment; after transition to another PM, continued to oversee delivery progress, risks, and stakeholder alignment through subsequent phases.

Liferay • Remote (Diamond Bar, CA, USA)

Engagement Manager (Professional Services | Software Delivery) • Full-time 10/2022 - 12/2023

- Managed and delivered 14 professional service projects for Fortune 500 organizations across the US, Canada, and the Caribbean, with budgets up to USD 300k.
- Drafted and negotiated 26 Statements of Work (SOWs), ensuring compliance with commercial agreements and successfully closing 16 deals.
- Led cross-functional delivery teams, including business analysts, developers, and testers, implementing, upgrading, and migrating on-prem Liferay Digital Experience Platform (DXP) and SaaS-based Liferay Experience Cloud (LXC).
- Oversaw discovery workshops with client stakeholders to identify pain points, gather comprehensive business requirements, and define tailored solutions aligned with business objectives and long-term strategies.
- Managed resources, utilization, and delivery forecasting across multiple projects in various locations and time zones, resulting in on-time delivery across committed milestones.
- Mitigated risks, managed dependencies, and minimized project delays by implementing a proactive customer onboarding process, reducing consultants' idle time to below 10% and increasing project profitability.
- Collaborated with Legal, Customer Success, and Engineering to advocate for client needs, align change requests, and drive project success.
- Coordinated communication between stakeholders, vendors, and technical teams, delivering presentations and tailoring information with a moderate level of detail based on the audience to ensure seamless project execution.

BCNET • Vancouver, BC, Canada

IT Project Manager (Network Infrastructure and Cybersecurity) • Full-time 05/2020 - 05/2022

- Oversaw 79 Network and Cybersecurity projects, managing up to 38 active initiatives simultaneously, consistently delivering on time and within budget.
- Improved network connectivity across 20 Post-Secondary Institutions (PSIs) campuses by coordinating infrastructure projects that integrated their networks into BCNET's high-speed network, delivering redundant connections to enhance reliability and performance.
- Enhanced network security by implementing Arbor Sightline and Cisco Crosswork Network Insights, enabling advanced DDoS detection and mitigation organization-wide.
- Cultivated a project management culture within the Technology Department by applying Change Management principles, resulting in improved planning, tracking, monitoring, and reporting processes.
- Transitioned from on-premise Jira to SaaS TeamDynamix, improving project data integrity and streamlining project management processes for greater efficiency.
- Developed and maintained comprehensive project documentation, including detailed project charters, schedules, and clearly defined requirements and deliverables, ensuring all stakeholders were aligned.

Career Break

04/2018 - 04/2020

- Career transition while relocating to Canada; invested in professional development, leadership/communication practice, and readiness to return to senior delivery roles.

EARLIER CAREER HIGHLIGHTS (Dell & HP) • Porto Alegre, RS, Brazil • Full-time

Senior Project Manager / Agile Project Manager (Software Development)

04/2014 - 03/2018

- Led enterprise software delivery across global programs, managing multi-million-dollar budgets and distributed, cross-functional teams (up to 30 people).
- Enabled measurable outcomes including 20,000-store migration for global eCommerce expansion, 93% reduction in monthly close effort, and compliance automation that eliminated translation costs and reduced audit risk.
- Strengthened delivery quality and speed through governance, Agile practices, and quality automation (<2% defect escape, 85% faster compatibility testing), consistently meeting committed milestones.

EDUCATION

Software Product Management Certificate (Specialization) — University of Alberta (Coursera), Canada

BEng, Electronic Engineering — Pontifical Catholic University of Rio Grande do Sul (PUCRS), Brazil

Accounting Degree — Protasio Alves College, Brazil

CERTIFICATIONS

Project Management Professional (PMP) — PMI | **Professional Scrum Master (PSM I)** — Scrum.org

SKILLS

Software delivery leadership, Professional Services delivery, Agile/Scrum delivery, SDLC governance, backlog refinement, requirement readiness, AI-assisted project management, workflow automation, AI-supported reporting and documentation, risk/action/dependency summarization, portfolio delivery, RAID/change control, resource and capacity planning, forecasting/utilization, delivery KPIs, process improvement, change management, cross-functional team coordination, stakeholder alignment, executive communication, QA coordination, release planning, client-facing delivery, consulting delivery leadership. Tools: Jira, Confluence, MS Project, Excel, Power BI, Salesforce, Mavenlink, Clockify.

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Eldorado Excellence Award — Effective leadership in a complex technology environment

Flash Award — New business prospects and process improvement

VOLUNTEERING & LEADERSHIP

PMI – Canadian West Coast Chapter — Mentor (Vancouver, BC)

PMI – Espírito Santo Chapter — Mentor (Vitória, ES, Brazil)

Douglas Toastmasters Club — Treasurer / Club Officer / Member (New Westminster, BC)

Community Leadership Programs — Instructor (Habitudes; YES! Career Direct)